

LESSON 6-6 • HOMEWORK PACKET • SHEET 1 OF 2

Simplifying to Show Equivalence

Maryland Standard 6.EE.A.3 • Learning target – I can simplify an expression by combining like terms to test whether two expressions are equivalent.

REMEMBER

- **Like terms** have the same variable part: $4x$ and $9x$ are like terms. $4x$ and 4 are not.
- Combine like terms by adding or subtracting coefficients: $4x + 9x = 13x$. A lone x is $1x$.
- Expressions are **equivalent** if they simplify to the same expression.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Are $5m + 8 + 2m - 3$ and $7m + 5$ equivalent?

Step 1 Combine the m terms: $5m + 2m = 7m$

Step 2 Combine the constants: $8 - 3 = 5$

Step 3 The first simplifies to $7m + 5$, the same as the second.

Answer Yes, they are equivalent.

PRACTICE

show your work • label units

1. Simplify each expression.

a. $6a + 3a =$ _____

b. $10y - 4y =$ _____

c. $x + 5x + 2 =$ _____

d. $7 + 3n + 4 =$ _____

e. $8b + 6 - 3b + 1 =$ _____

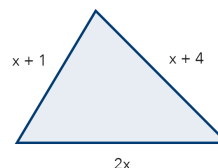
f. $2p + 9q + 5p =$ _____

g. $4m + 2 + m + 9 =$ _____

h. $12z - z =$ _____

2. **Perimeter.** The side lengths of the triangle are in centimeters. Write and simplify an expression for its perimeter.

Show your work.



Answer _____ cm

3. Are $3w + 3w$ and $6w^2$ equivalent?

☐ Yes

☐ No

4. Which expression is equivalent to $5x + 3 + 2x$?

☐ $10x$

☐ $7x + 3$

☐ $5x + 5$

5. **Find the Error.** Elena simplified $7x + 4 - 2x$ and wrote $9x$. Explain her mistake. Then simplify correctly.

CHECK YOURSELF

☐ I can do this on my own ☐ I need a little help ☐ I have a question about #_____

AT HOME Explain to someone at home why $4x + 4$ cannot be written as $8x$.

LESSON 6-6 • HOMEWORK PACKET • SHEET 2 OF 2**Testing and Justifying Equivalence**

Maryland Standard 6.EE.A.4 • Learning target – I can test whether two expressions are equivalent by substituting values and by reasoning.

REMEMBER

- Equivalent expressions have the **same value for every** value of the variable.
- **Test** with the same value in both. One value that gives different results proves they are **not** equivalent.
- Matching values do not prove it. **Justify** with properties, like the distributive property.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Are $4(n + 3)$ and $4n + 3$ equivalent?

Step 1 Test $n = 2$: $4(2 + 3) = 20$ and $4 \times 2 + 3 = 11$

Step 2 $20 \neq 11$. Distributing shows $4(n + 3) = 4n + 12$.

Answer Not equivalent

PRACTICE

show your work • label units

1. Evaluate each expression when $x = 5$. Which two might be equivalent?

a. $3(x + 4) = \underline{\hspace{2cm}}$

b. $3x + 12 = \underline{\hspace{2cm}}$

c. $3x + 4 = \underline{\hspace{2cm}}$

2. Write E if the expressions are equivalent or N if they are not.

a. $2(a + 5)$ and $2a + 10$ $\underline{\hspace{1cm}}$

b. $6b + 1$ and $7b$ $\underline{\hspace{1cm}}$

c. $c + c + c$ and c^3 $\underline{\hspace{1cm}}$

d. $8 + 4m - m$ and $3m + 8$ $\underline{\hspace{1cm}}$

3. **Counterexample.** Nate says n^2 and $2n$ are equivalent because both equal 4 when $n = 2$. Find a value of n that shows he is wrong.

Show your work.

Value and results _____

4. **Reason.** $3x$ and $x + 6$ are both 9 when $x = 3$. Which value of x shows they are **not** equivalent?

☐ $x = 3$

☐ $x = 4$

5. Which property shows that $5(m + 2) = 5m + 10$?

☐ Commutative

☐ Associative

☐ Distributive

TEST PRACTICE

choose the best answer

6. Which expression is equivalent to $7(p + 3)$?

A $7p + 3$

B $7p + 21$

C $p + 21$

D $10p$

7. Which expression is **not** equivalent to $4y + 8$?

A $4(y + 2)$

B $2(2y + 4)$

C $8 + 4y$

D $4(y + 8)$

CHECK YOURSELF

☐ I can do this on my own

☐ I need a little help

☐ I have a question about #_____

AT HOME Pick a number with someone at home. Do $2(x + 3)$ and $2x + 6$ give the same value? Try another number.